Caitlin Gilbert

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Experience

Washington Post, Data Reporter, January 2023 - Present

- Reports health, science, tech and politics stories and investigations with the Futures desk
- Uses data analysis, statistics and programming to tell stories with the data reporting team and other reporters
- Manages projects and investigations across news, visual and audience teams
- Mentors junior data reporters and interns through bulletproofing stories, technical tutorials and project editing

Lede Program (Columbia University), Teacher, June 2025 - Present

- Teaches R coding language for data journalism including analysis, visualization and statistics

Financial Times, Data Visualization Journalist, October 2021 - January 2023

- Reported US and global news stories across all beats using data analysis, graphics and statistics
- Developed and led all data-based projects and stories across US newsroom
- Collaborated with reporters and pitched to editors across global newsrooms on data and graphics-based stories

Reuters Graphics, Graphics Journalist (Contract), May 2021 - October 2021

- Worked on long-term and spot news-based graphics projects with broader international graphics team

Rockefeller University, PhD Student, September 2015 - May 2021

- Studied songbirds to understand the epigenetic basis of speech and language acquisition
- Developed novel bioinformatic pipelines to study genomic signatures of the songbird brain
- Applied data science tools including statistical analyses to understand phenomena and communicate research findings

Associated Press, Contractor, October 2020 - December 2020

- Worked on the Elections Scraping Team for several primary elections as well as the general election
- Researched specific election information for counties and states to establish best practices for web scraping/mining
- Analyzed how congressional and state-legislature balance of power changed during the November election

Summer Neuroscience Program, Co-Director, September 2017 - November 2020

- Led all aspects of competitive neuroscience outreach program for underserved NYC public high school students
- Taught advanced lectures on subjects including genetics, language development, and cognitive/neurodegenerative disorders

Awards

Edward R. Murrow Award for Continuing Coverage, 2026
Livingston Award for National Reporting (Finalist), 2026
Goldsmith Award for Investigative Reporting (Finalist), 2026
SABEW Best in Business Award for Data Journalism, 2026
National Press Club Joan M. Friedenberg Online Journalism Award, 2026
Online Journalism Awards (Finalist), 2025/2026
NIHCM Investigative and Data-Driven Storytelling Awards (Finalist), 2025/2026
NCDJ Katherine Schneider Journalism Award, 2024

Education

Rockefeller University, Doctor of Philosophy (PhD), Biomedical Sciences, 2015 - May 2021

Georgetown University, Bachelor of Science (BS), Neurobiology, 2009 - 2013

Skills and Languages

SOFTWARE: Data acquisition/analysis in R, Python, SQL and Bash | Github/Git, including collaborative work

ANALYSIS: Data visualization | hypothesis testing, statistical analyses | LLMs for extraction, classification, semantic search

GRAPHICS: 15 years of experience with Photoshop, Illustrator, and InDesign | HTML, CSS, and Javascript for websites

LANGUAGES: Spanish | Chinese (Mandarin)